Document chat app

UI and UX guide: the screens and how users move between them

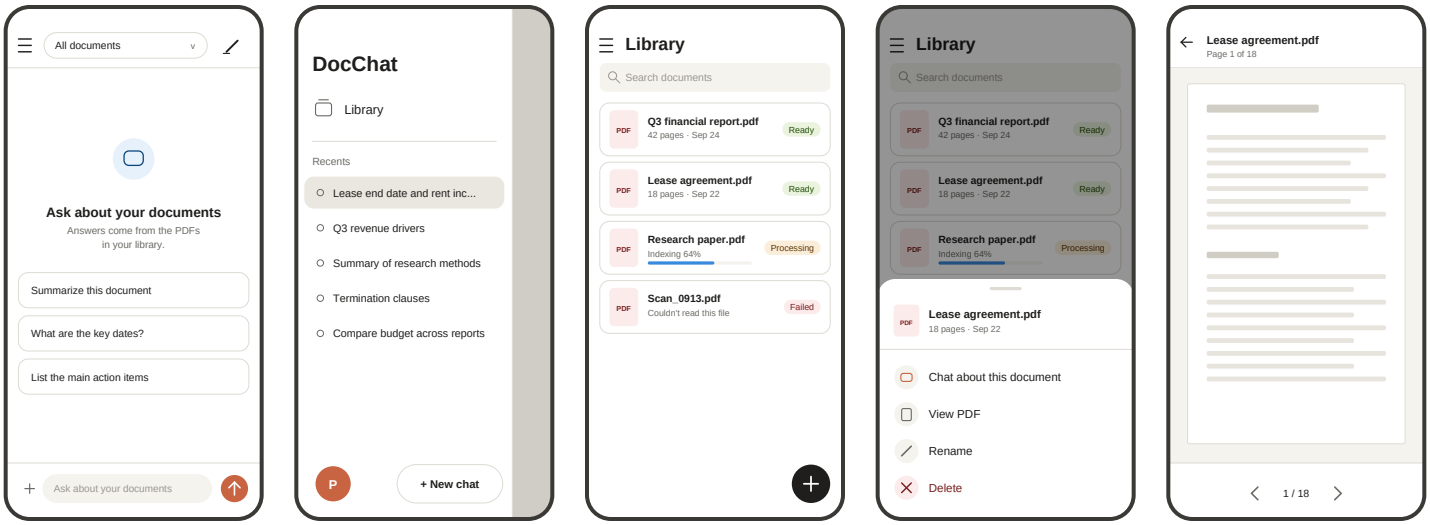
What the app does

Users upload PDFs to their own library, then chat with an assistant that answers questions from those documents. Every answer lists the files it used, so the user can see where the information came from.

The home screen and the sidebar

Chat is the home screen. The app opens on a chat that is ready for a question, searching all documents by default. Everything else is reached from one **sidebar**, opened with the menu icon: Library, past chats under Recents, New chat, and the profile menu.

The main screens



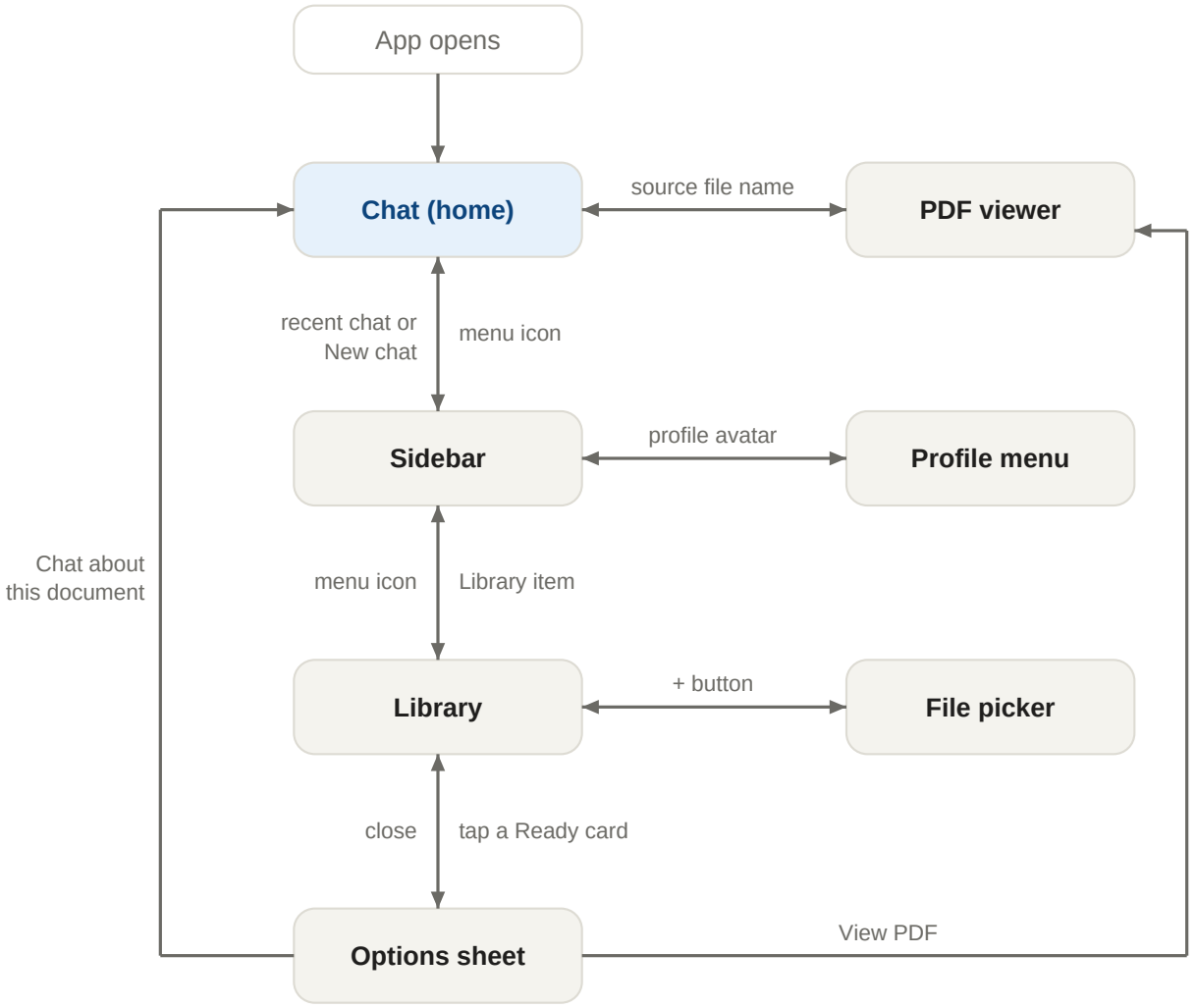
Chat (home) | **Sidebar** | **Library** | **Document options** | **PDF viewer**

How to read this guide

Page 2 is the navigation map and shows how the screens connect. Pages 3 to 8 cover each screen: what the user sees and what every tap does. Page 9 is a tap-by-tap summary and a short list of UX principles.

Navigation map

Where each tap leads, starting from the home screen



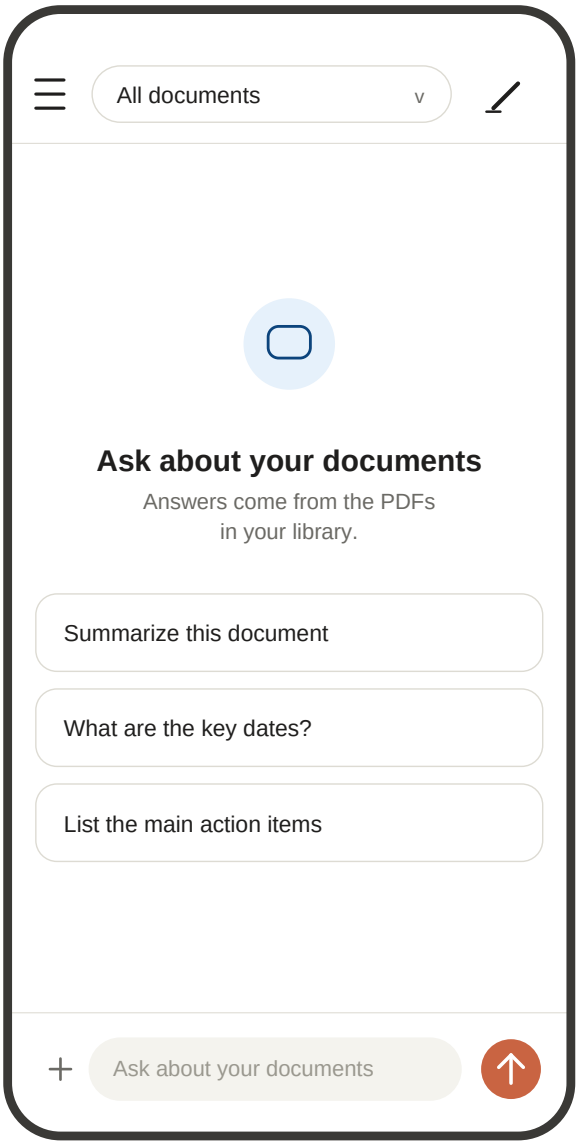
Two-headed arrows: tap to go forward, back or menu icon to return. The file picker, profile menu, and options sheet are pop-ups.

Typical journeys

- **Ask a question:** the app opens on Chat > type a question > read the answer and its sources.
- **Ask about one document:** menu icon > Library > tap a Ready card > Chat about this document.
- **Read a document:** menu icon > Library > tap a Ready card > View PDF.
- **Add a document:** menu icon > Library > tap + (or attach in chat) > pick a PDF > Processing, then Ready.
- **Check a source:** tap a file name under an answer > read the PDF > back arrow returns to the chat.
- **Start fresh:** pencil icon in the chat header, or New chat in the sidebar.
- **Return to an old chat:** menu icon > tap a chat under Recents.

1. Chat (home)

The home screen. The app opens here, ready for a question.

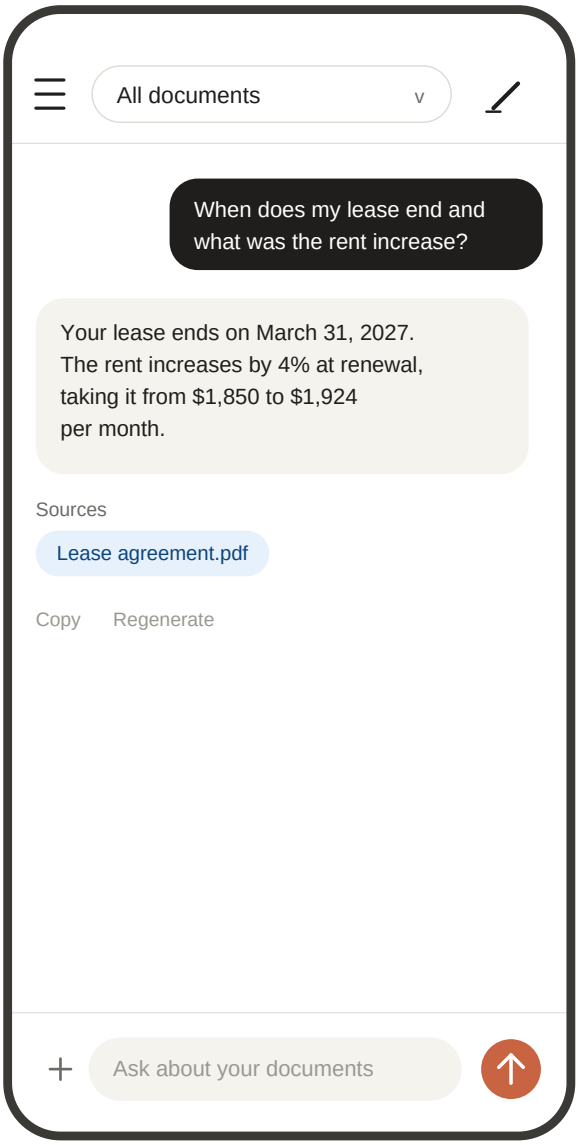


What the user sees

- A header with the menu icon, a scope selector, and a pencil icon.
- A short welcome line and three suggested prompts.
- A message box above the keyboard, with attach and send buttons.

What the user can tap

Tap	What happens
Menu icon	Opens the sidebar.
Scope selector	Lets the user pick All documents or a single document. It starts on All documents.
Pencil icon	Starts a new chat and clears the screen.
Suggested prompt	Sends it as the first question.
Attach button	Uploads a PDF without leaving the chat. It appears in Library as Processing.
Message box and send	Sends the user's own question.



2. Chat with answers

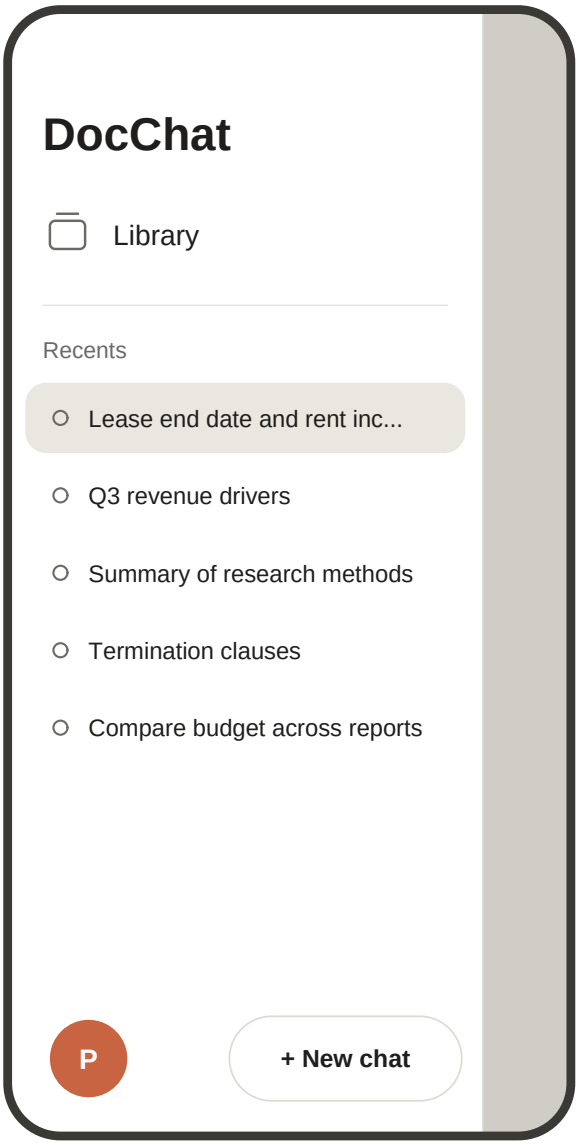
The same home screen after the first question. Answers stay on this screen.

What the user sees

- The user's question on the right and the answer on the left, appearing word by word.
- A Sources row under each answer that lists file names only.
- Copy and regenerate actions under the answer.

What the user can tap

Tap	What happens
Source file name	Opens that PDF in the viewer.
Copy	Copies the answer text.
Regenerate	Replaces the answer with a fresh one.
Scope selector	Changes which documents the next question searches.
Menu icon	Opens the sidebar.
Pencil icon	Starts a new chat.
Send button	Sends the next question.



3. Sidebar

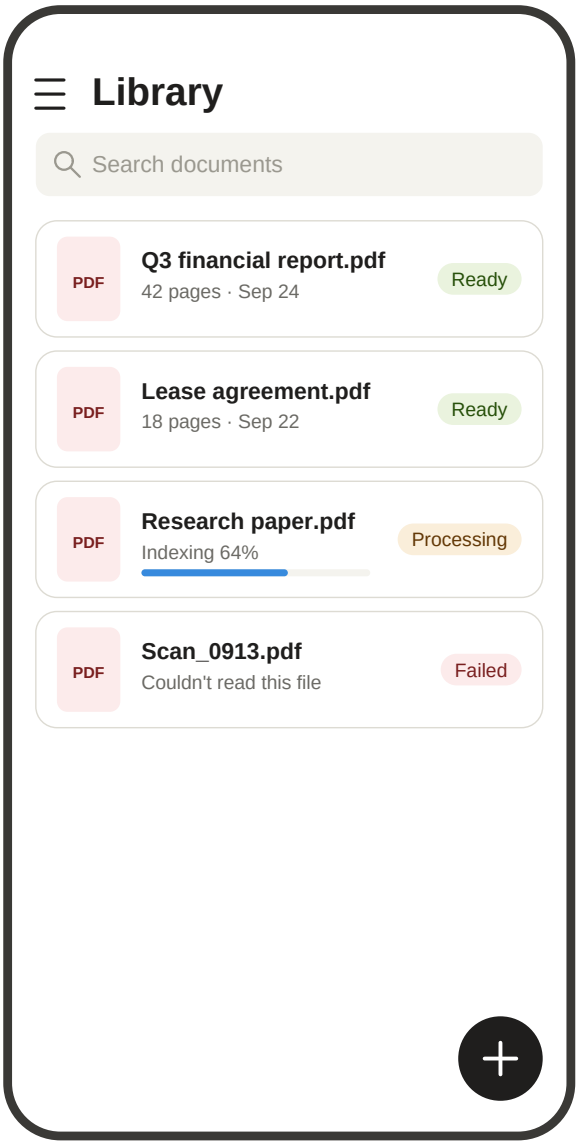
The one menu for the whole app. It holds Library, chat history, New chat, and the profile.

What the user sees

- The app name at the top and a Library item.
- A Recents list: past chats with the current one highlighted. It scrolls for older chats.
- The profile avatar at the bottom left and a New chat button at the bottom right, both within easy thumb reach.
- The chat behind is dimmed while the sidebar is open.

What the user can tap

Tap	What happens
Library	Opens the Library screen.
A chat under Recents	Opens that chat with its messages and scope, and closes the sidebar.
Long-press a chat	Shows Rename and Delete.
New chat	Opens a blank chat on the home screen.
Profile avatar	Opens a small menu with Sign out and Delete account.
Dimmed area or swipe left	Closes the sidebar.



4. Library

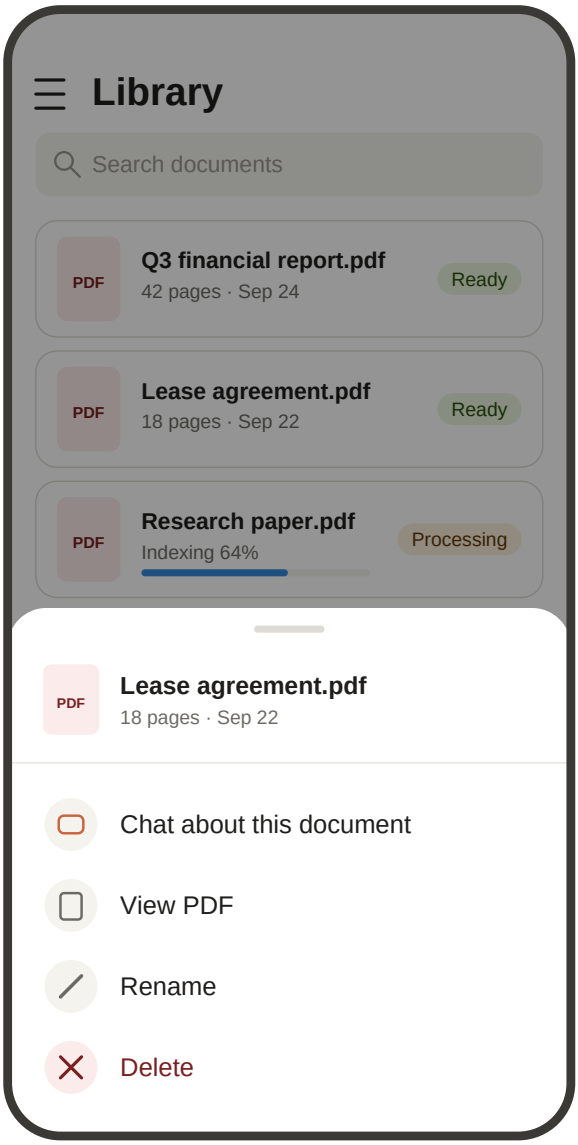
All uploaded documents. Opened from the sidebar.

What the user sees

- A card for each PDF with its name, page count, and upload date.
- A status chip on each card: Ready, Processing (with a progress bar), or Failed.
- A search bar, the menu icon, and a + button at the bottom right.

What the user can tap

Tap	What happens
Menu icon	Opens the sidebar.
Document card (Ready)	Opens the options sheet (next page).
Document card (Processing)	Shows progress. The options sheet is available once the card is Ready.
Document card (Failed)	Offers Retry or Delete.
Search bar	Filters the list as the user types.
+ button	Opens the phone's file picker. The chosen PDF appears as a new card marked Processing.



5. Document options

A bottom sheet that appears when the user taps a Ready document card in Library. The user chooses what to do instead of being sent somewhere automatically.

What the user sees

- The document's name, page count, and upload date at the top.
- Four actions: Chat about this document, View PDF, Rename, and Delete.
- The Library behind is dimmed.

What the user can tap

Tap	What happens
Chat about this document	Opens a new chat on the home screen with this document already selected as the scope.
View PDF	Opens the PDF viewer.
Rename	Shows a text box to change the file name.
Delete	Asks for confirmation, then removes the document from Library.
Dimmed area or swipe down	Closes the sheet.

6. PDF viewer

A simple reader for viewing a document or checking the source of an answer. It opens from a source file name in chat, or from View PDF in the options sheet.

What the user sees

- The file name and a page counter at the top.
- The document pages, with previous and next controls at the bottom.
- No highlights or extra tools, because sources show file names only.

What the user can tap

Tap	What happens
Scroll	Moves through the pages.
Pinch	Zooms in or out.
Previous and next	Moves one page back or forward.
Back arrow	Returns to where the user came from: the chat, or the Library.

9. Tap-by-tap summary

Every navigation path in one table

From	Tap	Goes to
App launch	Opens the app	Chat (home)
Chat	Menu icon	Sidebar
Chat	Pencil icon	Blank chat
Chat	Scope selector	Pick All documents or one document
Chat	Source file name	PDF viewer
Chat	Attach button	File picker, then a new card in Library
Sidebar	Library	Library
Sidebar	A chat under Recents	Chat with its saved messages
Sidebar	New chat	Blank chat
Sidebar	Profile avatar	Menu with Sign out and Delete account
Sidebar	Dimmed area or swipe left	Closes the sidebar
Library	Menu icon	Sidebar
Library	Document card (Ready)	Options sheet
Library	+ button	File picker, then a new card
Options sheet	Chat about this document	New chat with that document as scope
Options sheet	View PDF	PDF viewer
Options sheet	Rename	Text box to change the name
Options sheet	Delete	Confirmation, then removes the document
PDF viewer	Back arrow	Chat or Library, wherever the user came from

UX principles

- **Chat first:** the app opens on the thing users do most, asking a question.
- **One menu:** the sidebar holds everything else, so there are no hidden corners of the app.
- **Let the user choose:** tapping a document offers Chat, View, Rename, and Delete instead of guessing what they want.
- **Thumb-friendly:** New chat, the profile, the message box, and the options sheet all sit at the bottom of the screen.
- **Clear status:** every upload shows Processing, Ready, or Failed on its card.
- **Simple sources:** file names under each answer, one tap to open the PDF.
- **Dark mode from the start:** the same layout with a dark palette, as in the Claude app.
- **Back button:** the system back gesture closes the sidebar or sheet first, then steps back one screen. From Chat it leaves the app.